

Poverty in Contemporary Japan and the Challenges of the Welfare System

Theme: Contemporary Issues in Social Policy and Social Security

Abstract: Examines the current state of labor and welfare of people in poverty and poverty and considers improvement measures

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purpose

- A multifaceted analysis of the current situation and issues of poverty in contemporary Japan and the welfare system
- Problems such as low capture rate and stigma (social stigma) in welfare and their background
- **Considering the perception of "poverty"** and its history, which has expanded in multiple dimensions not only in terms of income but also in terms of health, educational background, and social participation.
- → Consider the direction of the welfare system to fulfill its original role of guaranteeing a "healthy and cultured minimum standard of living" for all citizens based on the principles of Article 25 of the Constitution.

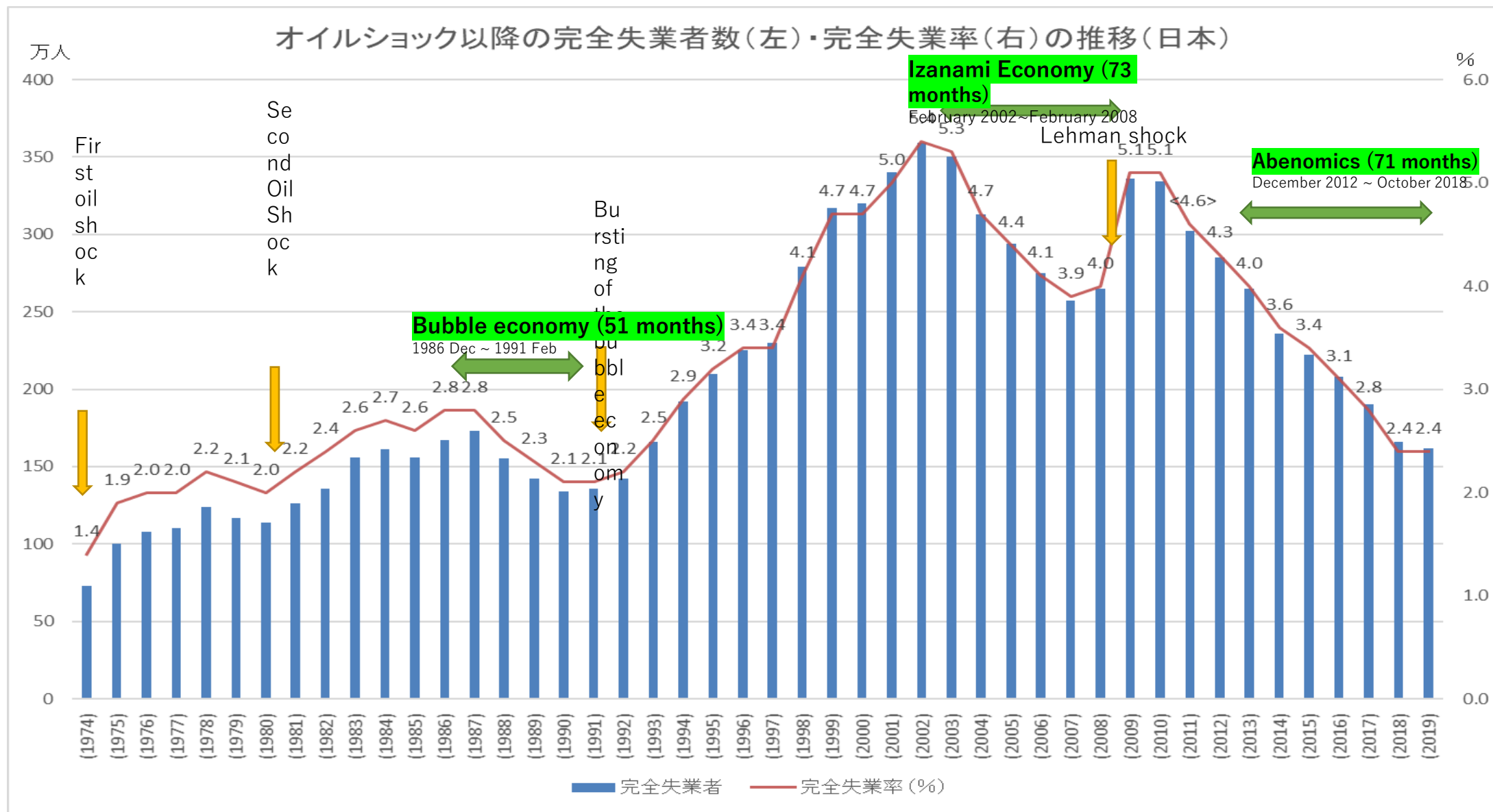
configuration

- Introduction: Poverty and the Current State of Safety Net in Japan
- Outline of the Public Assistance System
- Current Situation and Issues of the Public Assistance System
- Discussion: Why do problems arise?
- Conclusion: Future Prospects and Improvement Measures

Introduction

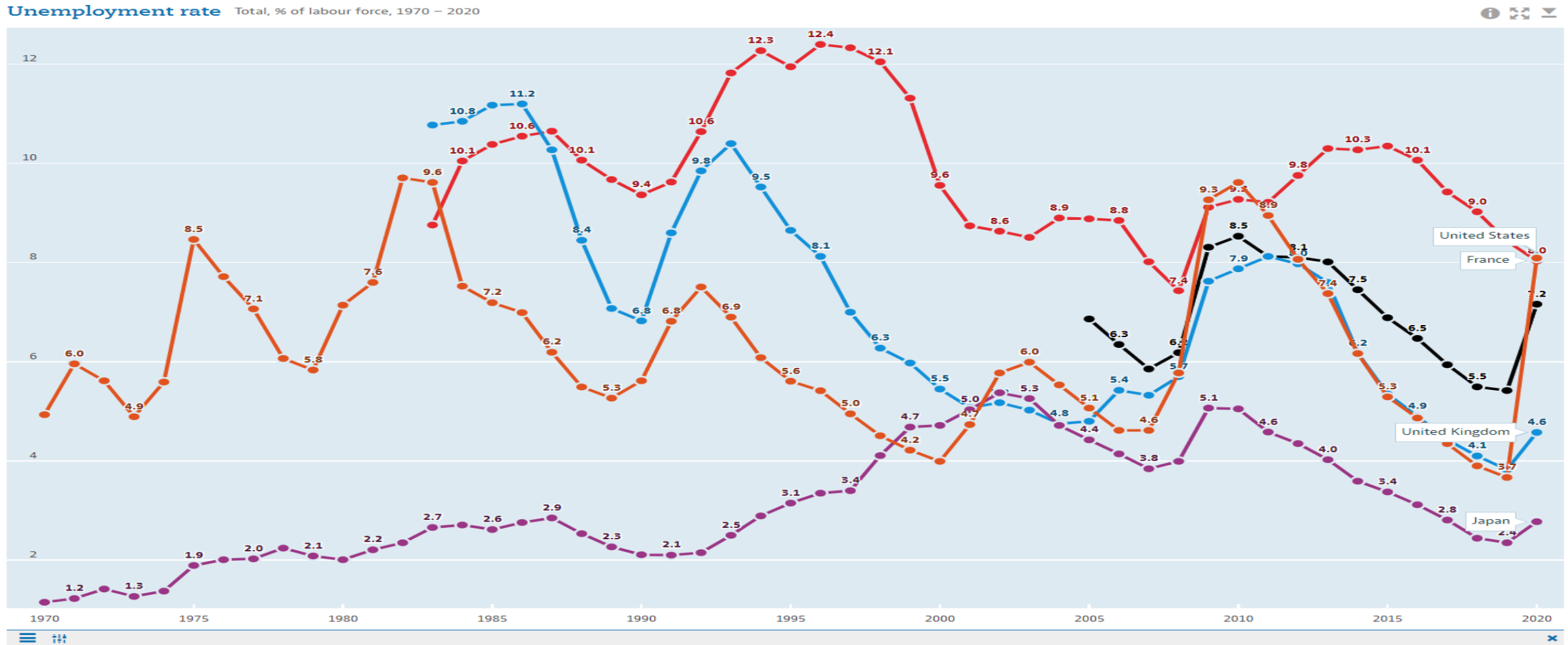
: Poverty and Safety Net in Japan

- Japan is a country with low unemployment compared to other countries, but there are many long-term unemployed people.
- Non-regular employment has increased rapidly since the late 90s
- The relative poverty rate is high compared to other countries.
- ← there is deregulation of the labor market and the dysfunction of the social security system



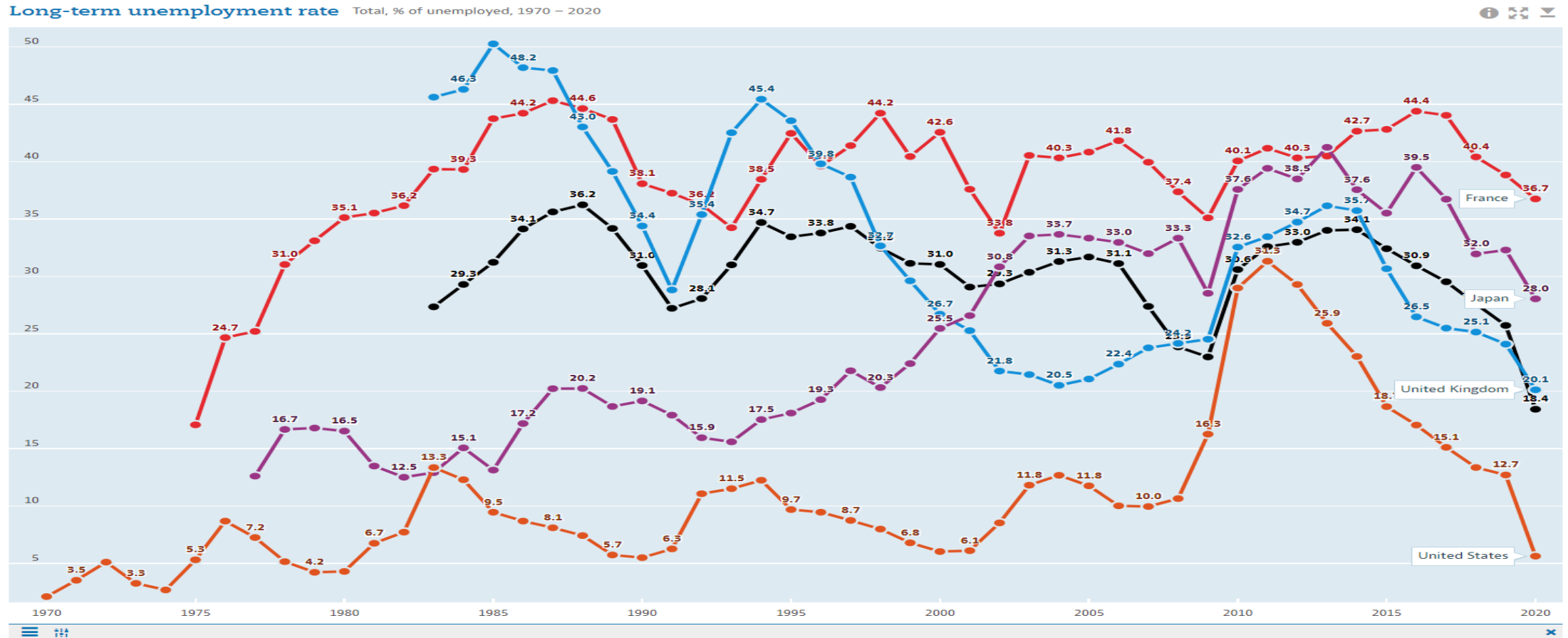
Created based on the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Communications' "Labour Force Survey"

Unemployment Rate in Major Countries



Source: OECD

Long-term unemployment rates in major countries



Source: OECD

Increase in the number of non-regular workers

単位(千人、%)															
		1987年		1992年		1997年		2002年		2007年		2012年		2017年	
役員を除く雇用者(1)		43,063	100.0	48,605	100.0	51,147	100.0	50,838	100.0	53,263	100.0	53,538	100.0	55,839	100.0
正規雇用(2)		34,565	80.3	38,062	78.3	38,542	75.4	34,557	68.0	34,324	64.4	33,110	61.8	34,514	61.8
	男	24,256	70.2	26,100	68.6	26,787	69.5	24,412	70.6	23,799	70.2	22,809	68.9	23,302	67.5
	女	10,309	29.8	11,962	31.4	11,755	30.5	10,145	29.8	10,526	30.7	10,301	31.1	11,211	32.5
非正規雇用(3＝1－2)		8,498	19.7	10,532	21.7	12,605	24.6	16,281	32.0	18,900	35.5	20,427	38.2	21,325	38.2
	男	2,427	28.6	2,862	27.2	3,358	26.6	4,780	29.4	5,911	31.3	6,483	31.7	6,678	31.3
	女	6,070	71.4	7,670	72.8	9,231	73.2	11,426	70.2	12,988	68.7	13,945	68.3	14,648	68.7
	パートタイマー	4,677	55.0	5,967	56.7	6,998	55.5	7,824	48.1	8,855	46.9	9,561	46.8	10,324	48.4
	アルバイト	1,886	22.2	2,514	23.9	3,344	26.5	4,237	26.0	4,080	21.6	4,392	21.5	4,393	20.6
	派遣労働者	87	1.0	163	1.5	257	2.0	721	4.4	1,608	8.5	1,187	5.8	1,419	6.7
	契約社員	－	－	－	－	－	－	2,477	15.2	2,255	11.9	2,909	14.2	3,032	14.2
	嘱託	730	8.6	880	8.4	966	7.7	1,059	5.6	1,059	5.6	1,193	5.8	1,193	5.6
	その他	1,118	13.2	1,008	9.6	1,025	8.1	946	5.8	1,043	5.5	1,185	5.8	964	4.5
	非正規内合計		100.0		100.0		100.0		100.0		100.0		100.0		100.0

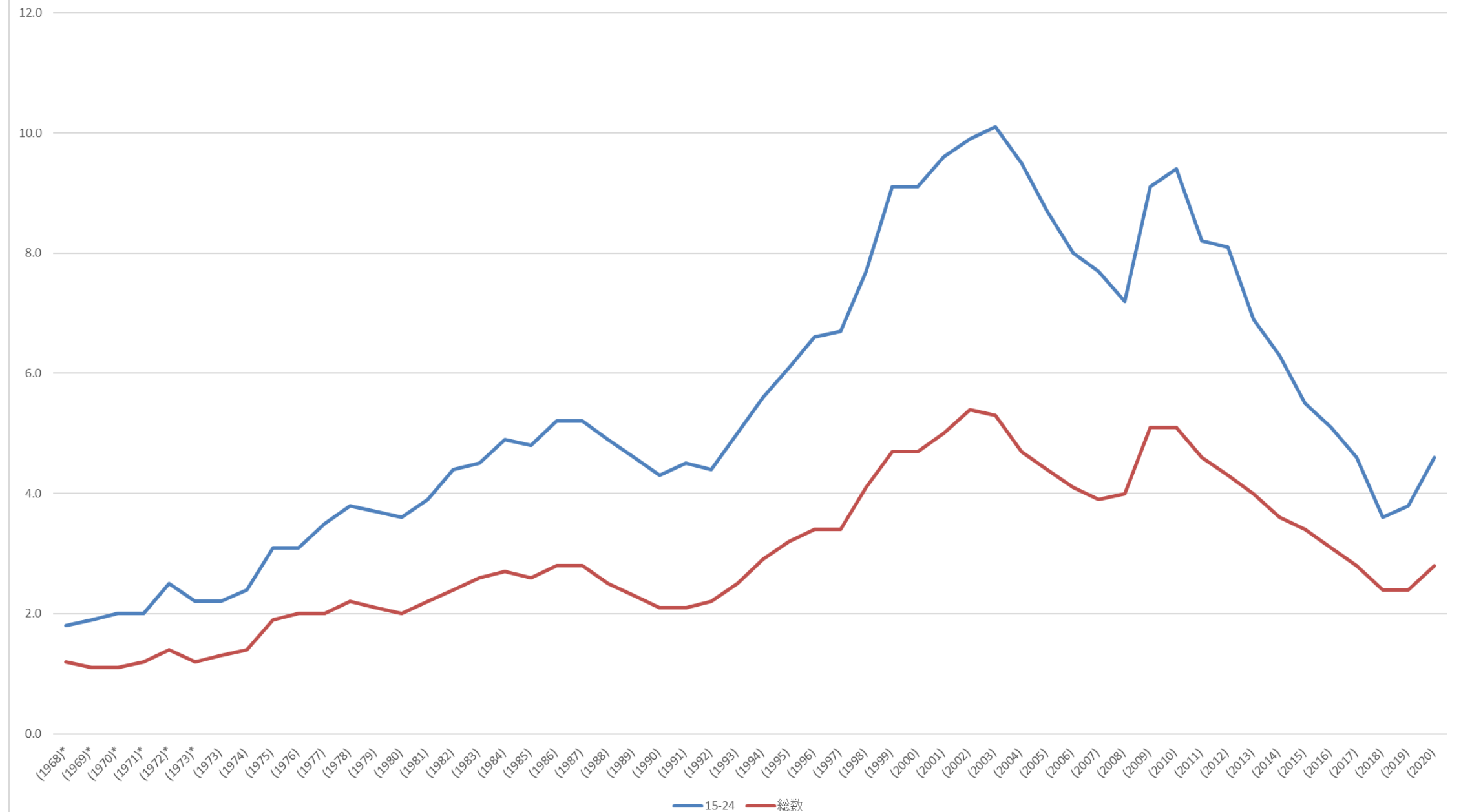
- Source: Created by the author from the Basic Survey on Employment Structure

Changes in the actual number and ratio of regular and non-regular employees among young people (15~24 years old)

	役員を除く雇用者	正規雇用者	非正規雇用者
1994 年 2 月	751 万人	584 万人 (77.8%)	167 万人 (22.2%)
2014 年 2 月	459 万人	223 万人 (48.6%)	236 万人 (51.4%)
2021 年 2 月	538 万人	268 万人 (49.8%) 男 139 万人 女 129 万人	270 万人 (50.2%) 男 128 万人 女 142 万人

Source: Ministry of Internal Affairs and Communications "Labour Force Survey"

15-24歳失業率の推移



Source: Labour Force

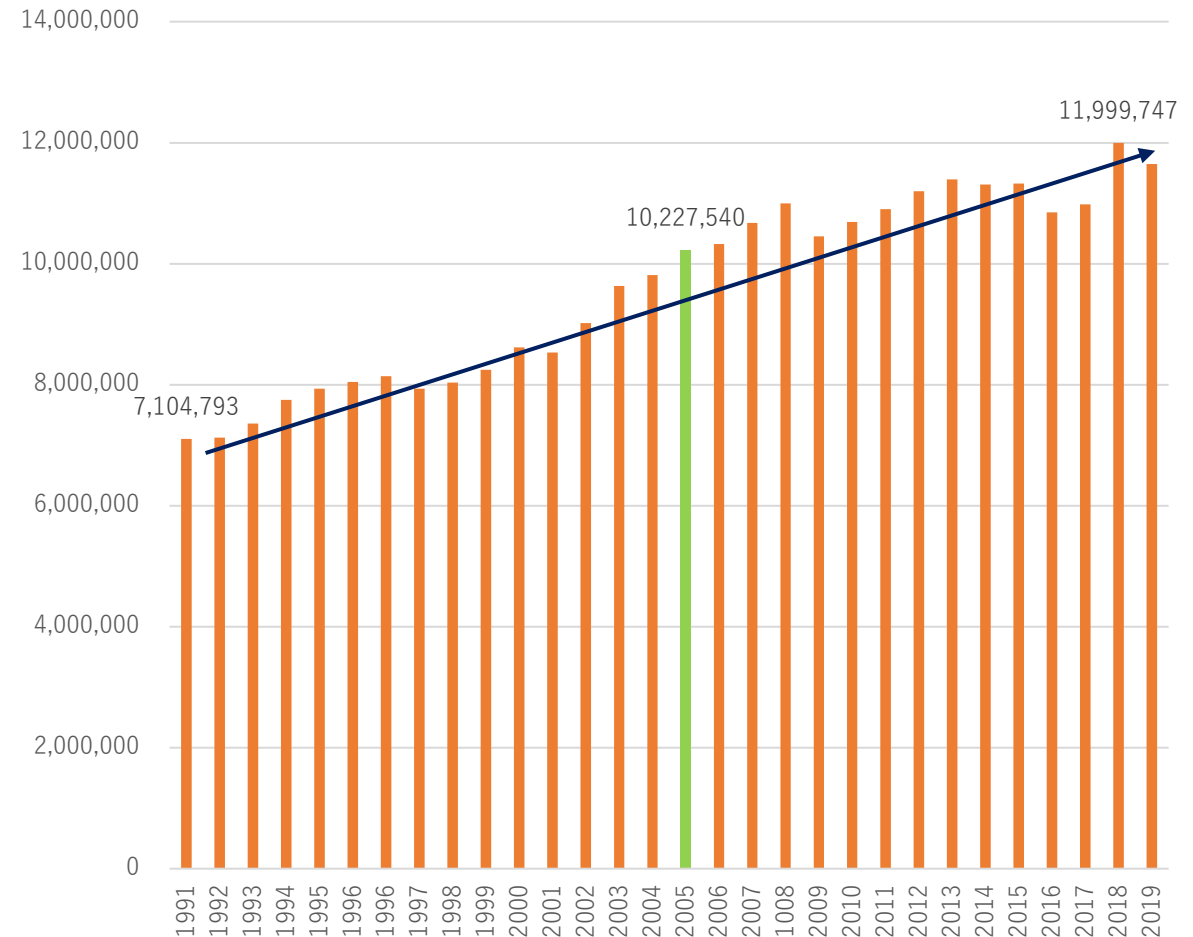
Progress of the Working Poor

- There are no official statistics for the working poor
- **Example: "Private sector workers whose annual income does not reach 2 million yen even if they work throughout the year": 12 million (1 in 5 of all employees)**

*** The annual living support cost for a family of three, a couple and one child, in one supply area 1 (Tokyo, etc.), is about 2 million yen.**

- 20 million workers do not reach 3 million yen (37.1% in the same survey)
- * According to the "Minimum Cost of Living Estimation Survey", 3 million for young people and single-person households (250,000 per month)

"Private sector workers whose annual income does not reach 2 million yen even if they work throughout the year"



Created based on long-term time-series data from the National Tax Agency's "Survey of Actual Salaries in the Private Sector"

Poverty criteria in relative poverty rate

	1985 (昭和60)年	1988 (63)	1991 (平成3)年	1994 (6)	1997 (9)	2000 (12)	2003 (15)	2006 (18)	2009 (21)	2012 (24)	2015 (27)	2018 (30)		2021 (令和3)年
												旧基準	新基準	新基準
相 対 的 貧 困 率	(単 位 : %)													
相 対 的 貧 困 率	12.0	13.2	13.5	13.8	14.6	15.3	14.9	15.7	16.0	16.1	15.7	15.4	15.7	15.4
子 ども の 貧 困 率	10.9	12.9	12.8	12.2	13.4	14.4	13.7	14.2	15.7	16.3	13.9	13.5	14.0	11.5
子 ども が い る 現 役 世 帯	10.3	11.9	11.6	11.3	12.2	13.0	12.5	12.2	14.6	15.1	12.9	12.6	13.1	10.6
大人が一人	54.5	51.4	50.1	53.5	63.1	58.2	58.7	54.3	50.8	54.6	50.8	48.1	48.3	44.5
大人が二人以上	9.6	11.1	10.7	10.2	10.8	11.5	10.5	10.2	12.7	12.4	10.7	10.7	11.2	8.6
中 央 値 (a)	(単 位 : 万 円)													
中 央 値 (a)	216	227	270	289	297	274	260	254	250	244	244	253	248	254
貧 困 線 (a/2)	108	114	135	144	149	137	130	127	125	122	122	127	124	127

注：1) 貧困率は、OECDの作成基準に基づいて算出している。

2) 大人とは18歳以上の者、子どもとは17歳以下の者をいい、現役世帯とは世帯主が18歳以上65歳未満の世帯をいう。

3) 等価可処分所得金額不詳の世帯員は除く。

4) 1994（平成6）年の数値は、兵庫県を除いたものである。

5) 2015（平成27）年の数値は、熊本県を除いたものである。

6) 2018（平成30）年の「新基準」は、2015年に改定されたOECDの所得定義の新たな基準で、従来の可処分所得から更に「自動車税・軽自動車税・自動車重量税」、「企業年金の掛金」及び「仕送り額」を差し引いたものである。

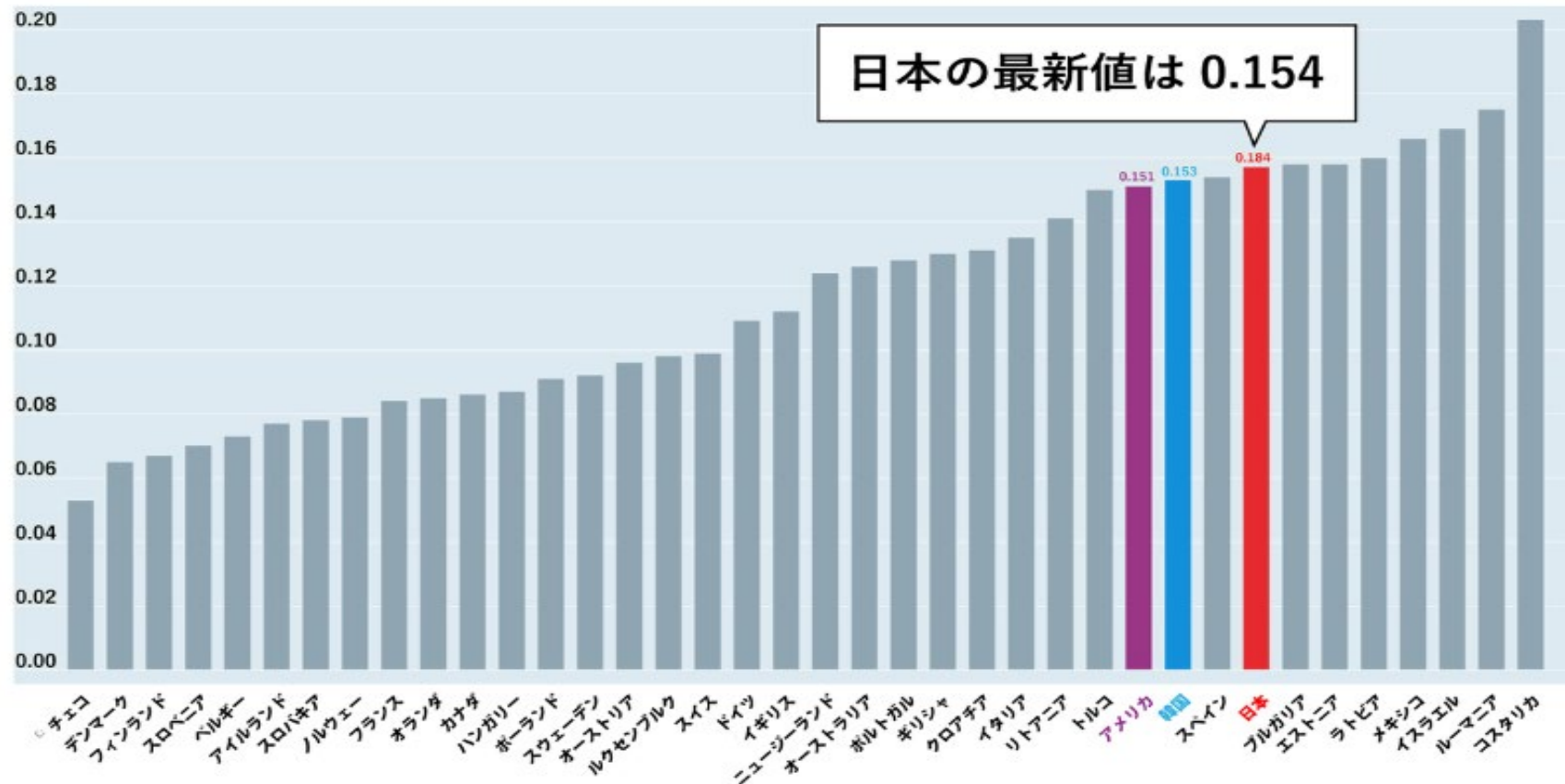
7) 2021（令和3）年からは、新基準の数値である。

The relative poverty rate refers to the percentage of household members whose

equivalent disposable income is less than 1.27 million yen (2021), and the poverty rate is 15.4%, or about 1 in 6.5 people

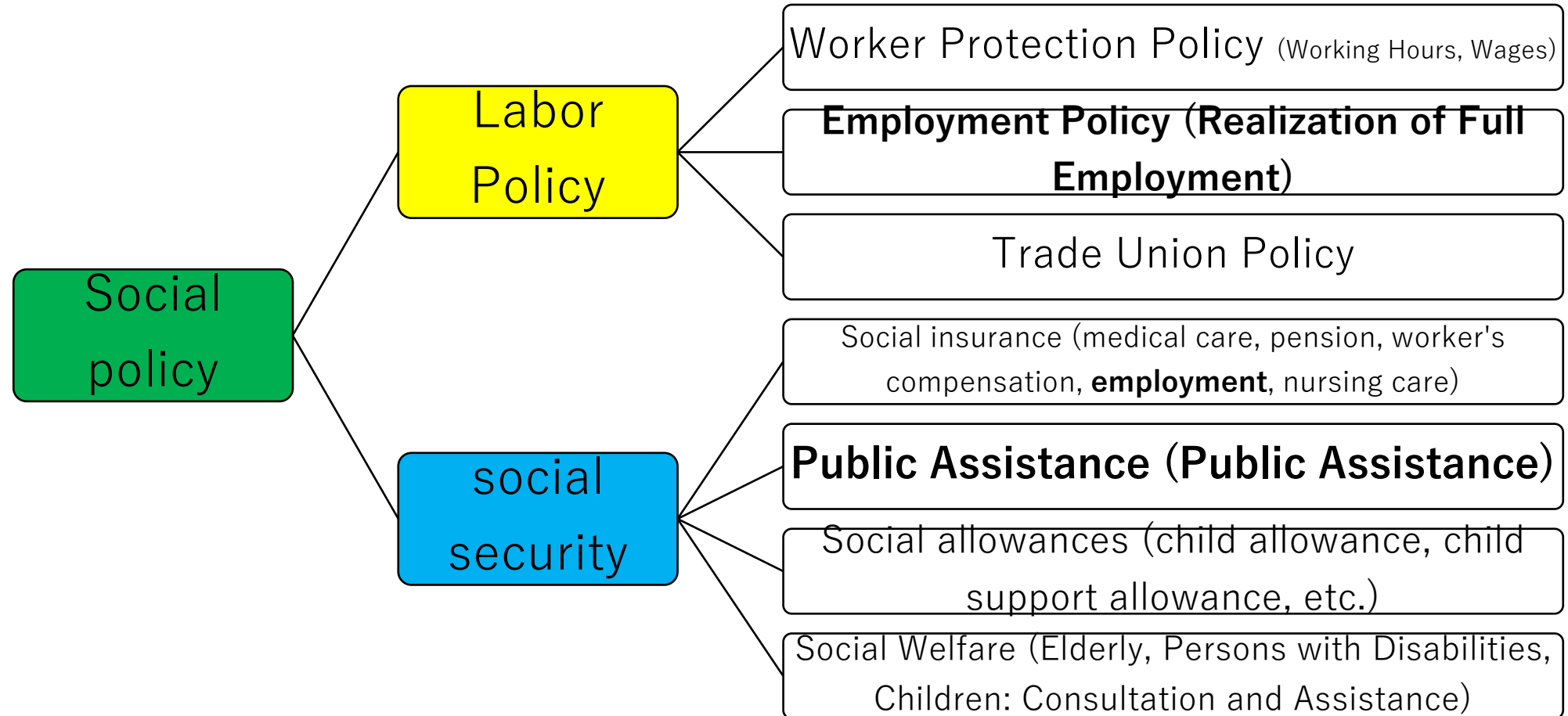
Reprinted from the Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare's "202

International Comparison of Relative Poverty Rates



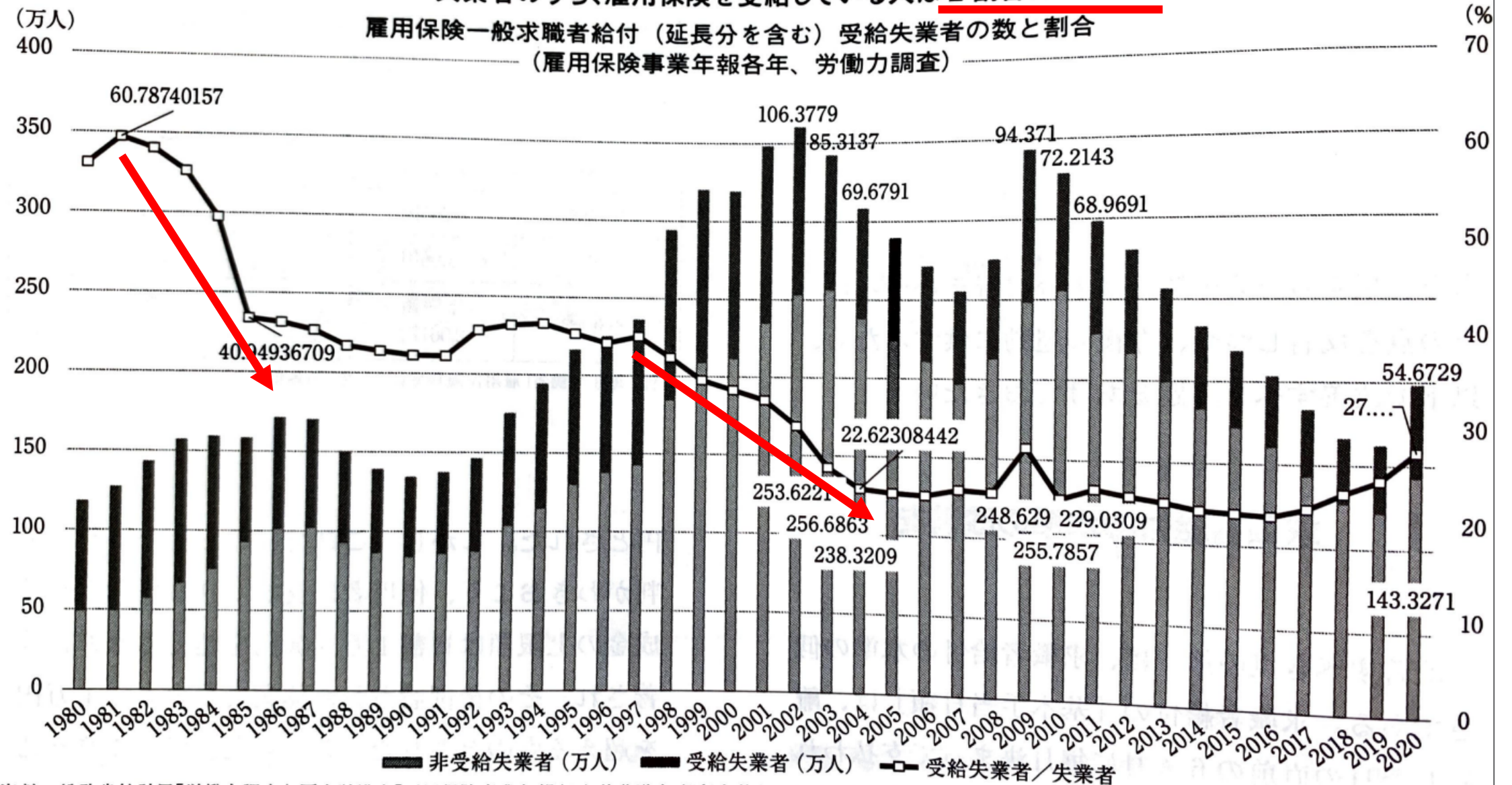
Source: Reprinted from the following article by Norihiro Oyama
<https://wedge.ismedia.jp/articles/-/30798?page=3>

System of Social Policy Theory



失業者のうち、雇用保険を受給している人は2割台にとどまる

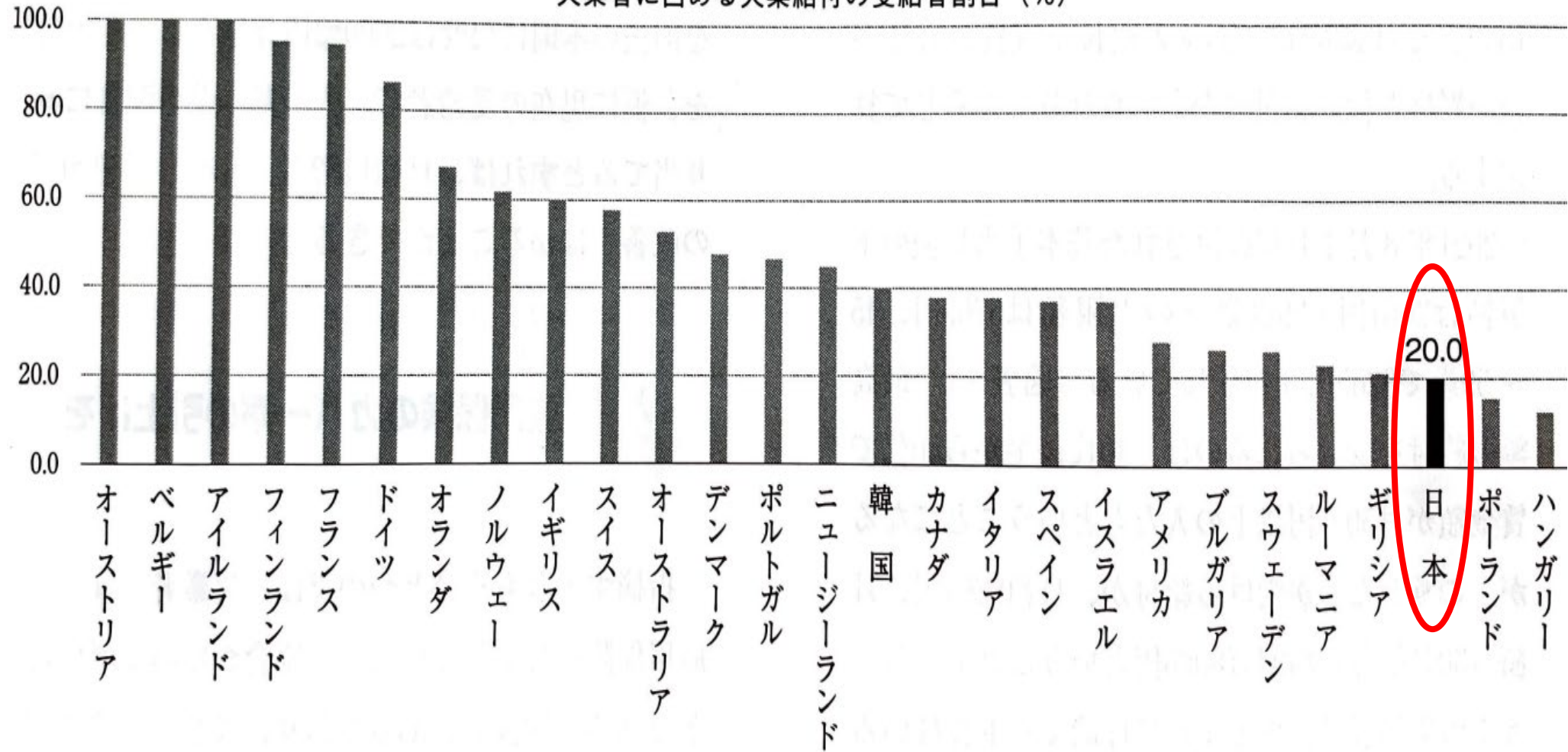
雇用保険一般求職者給付（延長分を含む）受給失業者の数と割合
（雇用保険事業年報各年、労働力調査）



資料：総務省統計局「労働力調査」、厚生労働省「雇用保険事業年報」より後藤道夫 都留文科大学名誉教授作成

諸外国に比べて雇用保険受給者割合は低い

失業者に占める失業給付の受給者割合 (%)



ILO Stat, SDG indicator1.3.1 より。各国 2014 年(ドイツのみ 2011 年)のデータをもとに筆者作成。

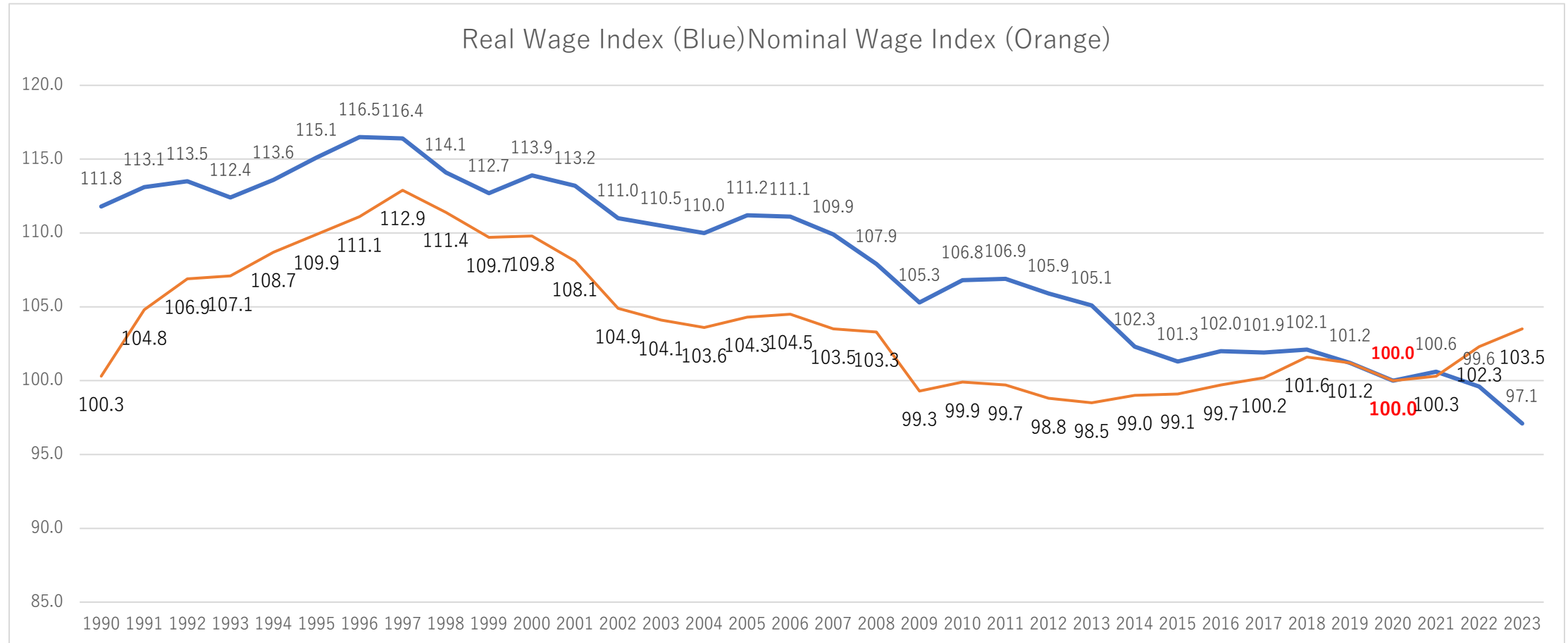
International Comparison of the Number of Welfare Recipients, Utilization Rate, and Capture Rate

	Population (people)	Number of welfare recipients (persons)	Utilization rate (%)	Capture rate (%)
Japan	127,000,000	¥1,998,957	1.60	15.3~18.0
Germany	81.77 million	7,935,000	9.70	64.6
France	65.03 million	3.72 million	5.70	91.6
United Kingdom	62,000,000	5,474,640	9.27	47.0~90.0
Sweden	9,415,570	¥422,320	4.50	82.0

Source: Reprinted from "Welfare 'Reform' This is the Focus!" supervised by the National Conference on Measures to Combat Welfare Problems (2011)

Wage index (comparison of nominal and real)

現金給与総額(Total cash earnings)



事業所規模(Size of establishments)：5人以上(Establishments with 5 employees or more)

就業形態(Type of Employment)：就業形態計(Total)

産業(Industry)：調査産業計(Industries covered)

出典 毎月勤労統計調査(MONTHLY LABOUR SURVEY)

Conversion of regular employees to the working poor

- Increase ≠ non-regular employment of the working poor
- Even for regular employees, wages have been declining since the end of the 1990s

Regular, male, 35-39 years old, and changes in distribution
(1997-2017)

	(%)			
	総計	10人～99人	100 ～999人	1000人 以上
300 万円未満	6.0→11.7	3.7→7.2	1.8→3.4	0.5→1.1
300～400 万円未満	13.2→17.4	7.3→8.3	4.5→6.4	1.4→2.7
400～500 万円未満	21.8→19.2	9.2→7.0	8.6→7.0	4.0→5.2
500 万円以上	53.7→38.3	10.6→6.0	16.8→11.5	26.3→20.8

(資料) 総務省「平成 9 年就業構造基本統計調査」第 2002 表, および
「平成 29 年就業構造基本統計調査」第 45 表から作成。

Reprinted from Yasuo Fukuda (2021) "The Mystery
of a Disparity Society: A Guide to a Sustainable
Society," p. 140

Outline of the Public Assistance System

Based on the principles of Article 25 of the Constitution, the welfare system should fulfill its original role of guaranteeing a "healthy and cultured minimum standard of living" for all citizens?

Purpose of the welfare system

- Purpose: Minimum living security and promotion of independence
- Article 1 of the Public Assistance Act; Based on the principles stipulated in Article 25 of the Constitution of Japan, this Act aims to provide necessary protection to all citizens in need according to the degree of their need, to guarantee their minimum standard of living, and to promote their independence."
- The above objectives are based on the guarantee of the right to life in Article 25 of the Constitution

Article 25 of the Constitution

- 1. Every citizen has the right to a **healthy and cultured minimum standard of living**.
- 2. The State shall endeavor to improve and promote social welfare, social security and public health in all spheres of life.

The four basic principles of welfare:

- **Principle of State Responsibility:** The state is responsible for protecting its citizens in need.
- **Principle of non-discrimination and equality:** Equal protection without discrimination based on race, creed, gender, social status, etc.
- **Principle of Healthy and Cultural Minimum Living Guarantee:** Based on the principles of Article 25 of the Constitution, we guarantee not only survival, but also a decent life.
- **Principle of subsidiarity:** Protection is provided in the form of compensating for the shortfall in the absence of a minimum standard of living despite the use of the assets, abilities, and everything else available to the person

What is a healthy and cultural minimum standard of living?

- **Minimum cost of living:** The minimum standard of living guaranteed by the government
- Article 8 of the Public Assistance Law; Protection shall be based on the needs of persons in need of protection as measured by standards established by the Minister of Health, Labour and Welfare, to the extent of making up for the shortfall that cannot be met by their money or goods."
- Minimum living expenses are calculated according to the situation of the household based on 8 types of assistance (living, housing, education, nursing care, medical care, childbirth, funeral, livelihood)
- Minimum Living Expenses - Allowance = Living Allowance

Application Principle



- ・生活保護制度の説明
- ・生活福祉資金、障害者施策等
各種の社会保障施策等の紹介
や助言

- ・預貯金、保険、不動産等の資産調査
- ・扶養義務者による扶養の可否の調査
- ・年金等の社会保障給付、就労収入等
の調査
- ・就労の可能性の調査

- ・最低生活費から収入を引いた額を支給
- ・世帯の実態に応じて、年数回の訪問調査
- ・収入、資産等の届出の受理、定期的な
課税台帳との照合などを実施
- ・就労の可能性のある者への就労指導

Agencies implementing the protection and the cost burden

- ・ 都道府県、市、福祉事務所を設置する町村が実施。
- ・ 都道府県・市は、福祉事務所を設置し、被保護世帯に対して担当のケースワーカーを設定。
 - ※ 福祉事務所の設置状況は、全国で1, 248カ所（都道府県207、市998、町村43（平成30年4月1日現在））
 - ※ 福祉事務所の所員の定数は条例で定める。ただし、厚生労働省としては、以下の数を標準数として示している。
 - （市）被保護世帯240以下の場合：標準数3・被保護世帯80増すごとに1追加
 - （都道府県）被保護世帯390以下の場合：標準数6・被保護世帯65増すごとに1追加
- ・ 保護費については、国が3／4、地方自治体が1／4を負担。

Current Situation and Issues of the Public Assistance System

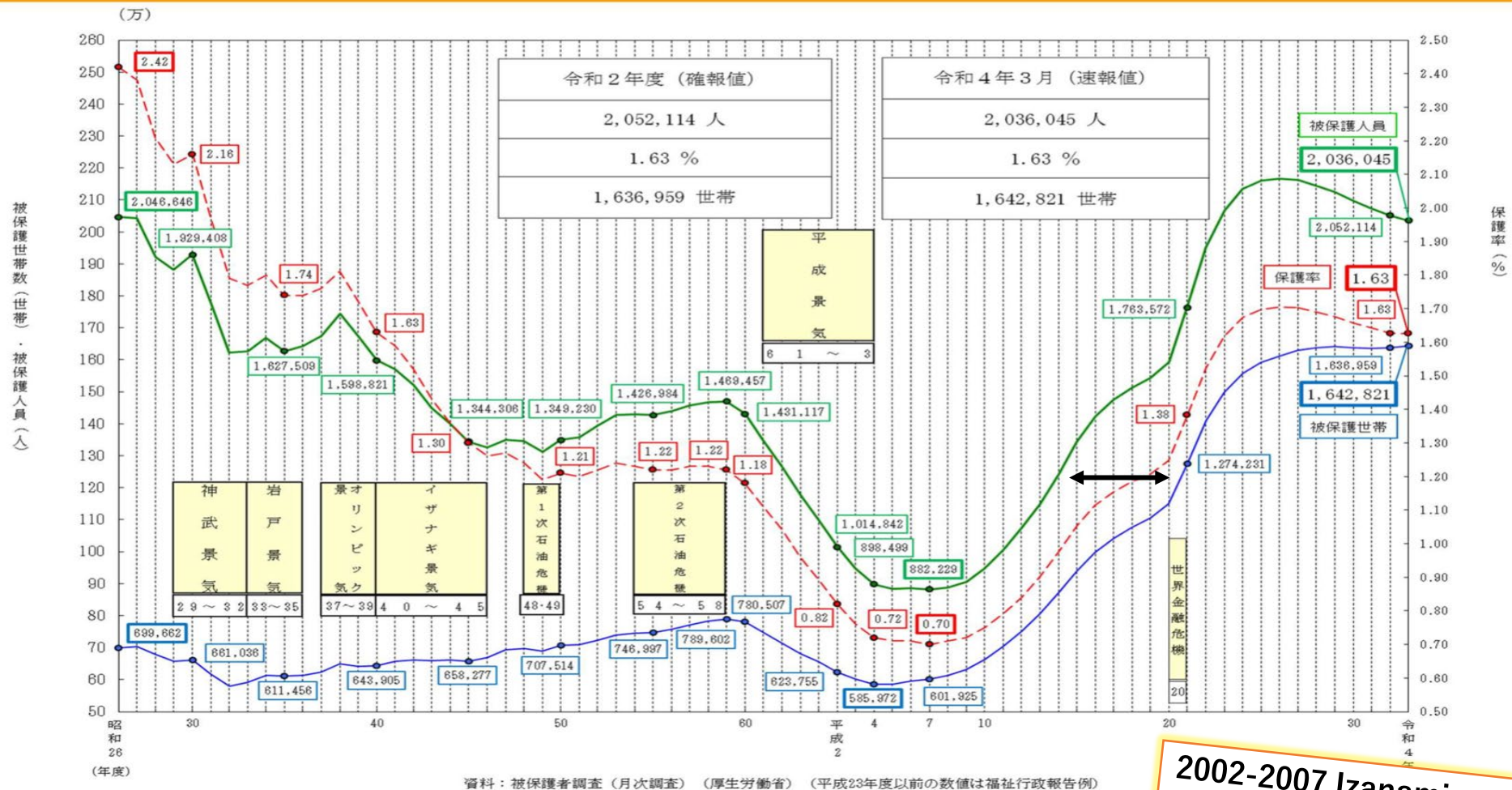
Half of the beneficiaries are seniors

Low Capture

Welfare bashing and the resulting lowering of living standards

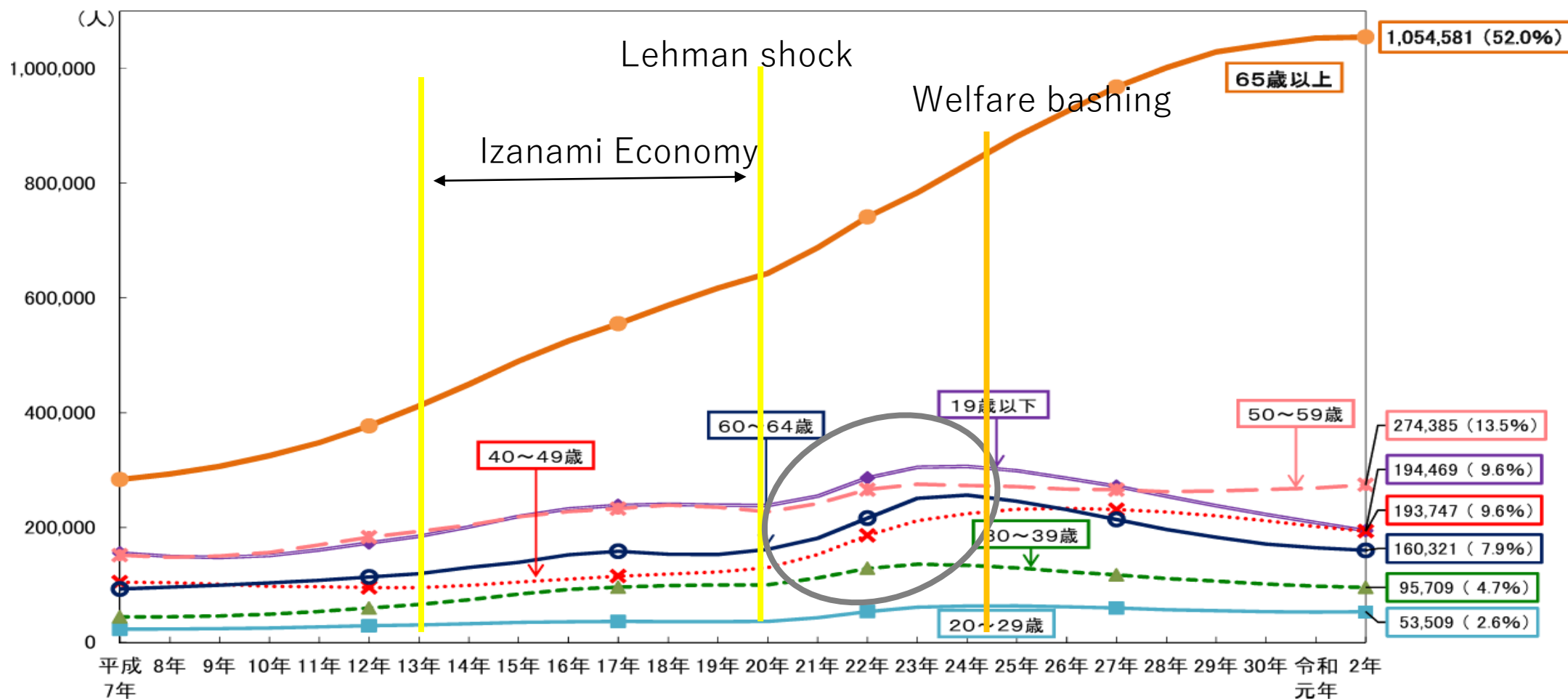
Protected Persons, Protection Rate, Number of Protected Persons (over the years)

- 生活保護受給者数は約204万人。平成27年3月をピークに減少に転じた。
- 生活保護受給世帯数は約164万世帯。高齢者世帯が増加している一方、母子世帯は減少傾向が続いている。



年齢階級別被保護人員の年次推移

- 年齢階級別の被保護人員の推移をみると、65歳以上の者の増加が続いている。
- 被保護人員のうち、**半数は65歳以上の者**となっている。

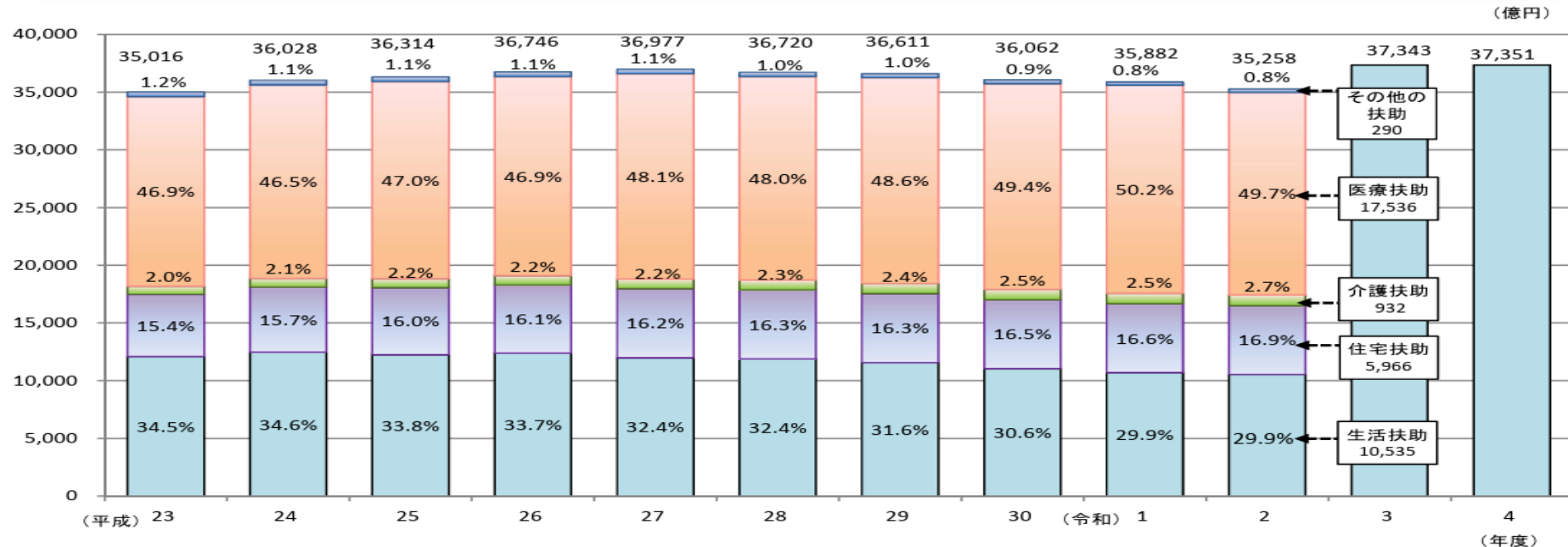


資料：被保護者調査 年次調査（厚生労働省）（平成23年以前は被保護者全国一斉調査）[令和2年は速報値] ※各年7月調査日時点

Changes in the actual amount of welfare expenses (based on business expenses)

生活保護費負担金(事業費ベース)実績額の推移

- 生活保護費負担金(事業費ベース)は約3.7兆円(令和4年度当初予算)。
- 実績額の約半分は医療扶助。



資料：生活保護費負担金事業実績報告

- ※1 施設事務費を除く
- ※2 令和2年度までは実績額、令和3年度は補正後予算、令和4年度は当初予算
- ※3 国と地方における負担割合については、国3/4、地方1/4

Low take-up rate

- **Definition:** Percentage of people who are eligible for welfare and who are actually using it
- **Current Status:** Extremely low compared to other countries
- **Important factor:**
- ☒ Inappropriate response at the counter (border operation): Inadequate explanation of the system, intimidating response, and dependency inquiry (inquiry to relatives) make the application hesitant (Naohiro Kawakubo (2017), "Actual Operation of Local Government's Welfare System and Social Costs," Capital and Region, Vol. 12, pp. 28-47)
- ☒ Stigma: Negative images such as "shame" and "laziness" and the psychological resistance associated with them, etc.

(Kenichi Kurita (2017), "A Survey of Economic Research on the Stigma of Public Welfare," Economic Review, No. 158, pp. 1-6)

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Source: Supervised by the National Conference on Measures to Combat Welfare Problems (2011) "Welfare 'Reform':
This is the Focus!"

Welfare bashing and the resulting lowering of welfare levels

- **In 2012, when it was** reported in the media that relatives of celebrities were receiving welfare benefits as if they were fraudulently receiving welfare benefits (even though they were not legally fraudulently receiving benefits), media coverage of welfare recipients and the welfare system became overheated (mainly accusations and attacks).
- In the process, a negative image was created of welfare recipients as lazy, fraudulent and cunning people, and negative public opinion was formed against welfare
- ⇒ 2013: Strengthening penalties for fraudulently receiving benefits, strengthening inquiries about dependents at the time of application, and lowering of living assistance

Reduction of welfare payments

- Fiscal 2003: 0.9% (the first reduction since the establishment of the system in 1950)
- Fiscal 2004: 0.2%
- In December 2012, the Liberal Democratic Party (LDP) government returned to power → In January of the following year, the standard of living assistance was proposed to be cut
- **August 2013 ~ April 2015:** Gradual reduction (total 67 billion yen over 3 years, average 6.5%, maximum 10%, 96% of welfare households affected)
- 9.0 billion yen: Adjusted for the impact of age, households, personnel, and regional differences based on the results of the verification by the Standards Subcommittee, 58.0 billion yen based on the decline in prices since the 2004 review.
- October 2018 ~ October 2020: Gradual reduction (total of 21 billion yen over 3 years, 67% of protected households affected)

Welfare Reduction Lawsuit

- More than 10,000 users in all prefectures are dissatisfied and request a review
- Claiming that it violates Article 25 of the Constitution, which stipulates the right to life, he has held a "trial for life" to demand the cancellation of the reduction penalty. More than 1,000 plaintiffs in courts in 29 prefectures nationwide
- The main point of contention is whether or not to introduce **a "deflationary adjustment" that** reflects the decline in prices
- → On June 27, the Supreme Court ruled that "the reduction is illegal," and the government lost the case.

Discussion: Why do problems arise?

Difficulty in reaching a common understanding of what poverty is

What is poverty?

- Poverty is **"a living condition that should not exist"** (Shiga 2022:8)
- **If a value judgment (social judgment) is made** that the living conditions "should not exist", it will be socialized as a problem that needs to be solved→
- **The difficulty of poverty countermeasures** is that each **person has a different understanding of the content and standards of "living conditions that should not exist"** ⇒bashing and defending them.
- "Historically, poverty has mostly been considered in terms of income, but now there is a movement to consider the **minimum level of equality** by including factors that enrich one's life, such as health, motivation, and educational attainment." Shiga Ibid.: 26)

*Nobuo Shiga (2022) "Introduction to Poverty Theory: Equality of Freedom through Solidarity" Horinouchi Publishing

* Underlining and bold are added by Ozawa.

The process of expanding the semantic content of "living conditions that should not exist"

	Living conditions that should not be Specific content of (concept of poverty)	Characteristics of the indicator	Details of poverty measures
Absolute poverty (End of 19C~)	Living conditions that lack physical viable nutrition	Centralized (mainly income and consumption)	Monetary and in-kind benefits Employment Support (Labor Market Policy)
Relative poverty Relative deprivation (1960s~)	A living condition in which social participation that is not ashamed of being a social being is not guaranteed	Multidimensional (not only income, but also lack of living resources, social participation , etc.)	Monetary and in-kind benefits Employment Support (Labor Market Policy) Development of social capital
Social exclusion	Living conditions in which access to various rights related to life (social rights) is not guaranteed, and living	In addition to multidimensional indicators, dynamic	Monetary and in-kind benefits Employment Support (Labor Market Policy)

Poverty measurement by deprivation index (Definition of Relative deprivation)

- "The state of writing about the resources of life necessary to eat the kind of food that is habitual in the society to which it belongs, or at least widely encouraged or endorsed, to participate in social activities, or to obtain the necessities and comforts of life" (Townsend 1979, p. 31).
- Individuals, families and groups in the population can be said to be in poverty when they lack resources to obtain the types of diet, participate in the activities and have the living conditions and amenities which are customary, or are at least widely encouraged or approved, in the societies to which they belong (Townsend 1979, p.31) .

Townsend, P. (1979) *Poverty in the United Kingdom*, Allen Lane

Townshend's Deprivation Index Items

- Deprivation index consisting of 60 items in 12 fields such as

1. 過去12ヵ月間に1週間の休暇を家の外で過ごしていない。
2. (大人のみ) 過去4週間に親類または友人を家に招き、食事もしくは軽食をとったことがない。
3. (大人のみ) 過去4週間に親類または友人の家を訪ね、食事もしくは軽食をとったことがない。
4. (15歳未満の子供のみ) 過去4週間の間に友人を家に呼んで遊んだりお茶を飲んだりしたことがない。
5. (15歳未満の子供のみ) 前回の誕生日にパーティーを開かなかった。
6. 過去2週間の間に娯楽のために午後または晩に外出したことがない。
7. 1週間に4日以上新鮮な肉（外食をふくむ。ソーセージ・ベーコン・ハムなどを除く）を食べることがない。
8. 過去2週間に、料理された食事を食べない日が1日以上あった。
9. 「1週間のうちほとんどの日に、料理された朝食（ベーコンエッグなどを含む）をとっている」ということがない。
10. 家には冷蔵庫がない。
11. 「通常（4回のうち3回以上）日曜日に、大きな肉片を食べる」ということがない。
12. 家の中に次の4種の室内設備のいずれかがない（共用設備を除く）……水洗トイレ/流しまたは洗面台、および水の出る蛇口/固定された風呂またはシャワー/ガスまたは電子レンジ

注：和訳は平岡（2001：154-155）をもとに一部修正して作成した。

出所：Townsend（1979：250）、平岡（2001：154-155）より筆者ら作成。

From poverty to social exclusion

(1) From single-dimensional to **multi-dimensional**

- While the poverty index measures only one-dimensional events such as income and consumption, the social exclusion index consists of multiple items using multidimensional data such as lack of social relations, exclusion from the labor market, lack of educational opportunities, and lack of daily necessities

(2) From one point in time to **multiple points** in time

- **We focus on the process** leading to elimination by observing changes in state at multiple time points. For this purpose, it is necessary to have panel data that follows individuals and households over a long period of time and over multiple years, rather than one-point data

(3) From individual and household units to **spatial** units

- The unit of exclusion is not an individual, but a spatial unit, such as a region or a country. Ex. Local safety (crime rate, etc.), good or bad environment, and national or regional unemployment rate (not whether or not individuals are unemployed) are some of the indicators.
- By including regional and national indicators, we will try to grasp **the factors that lead to social exclusion from the perspective of the environment in which the excluded person is placed**, rather than as an individual problem. **Policies of social inclusion** will also be implemented at the regional and national levels.

(4) **Subjective indicators** in addition to objective indicators are also targeted.

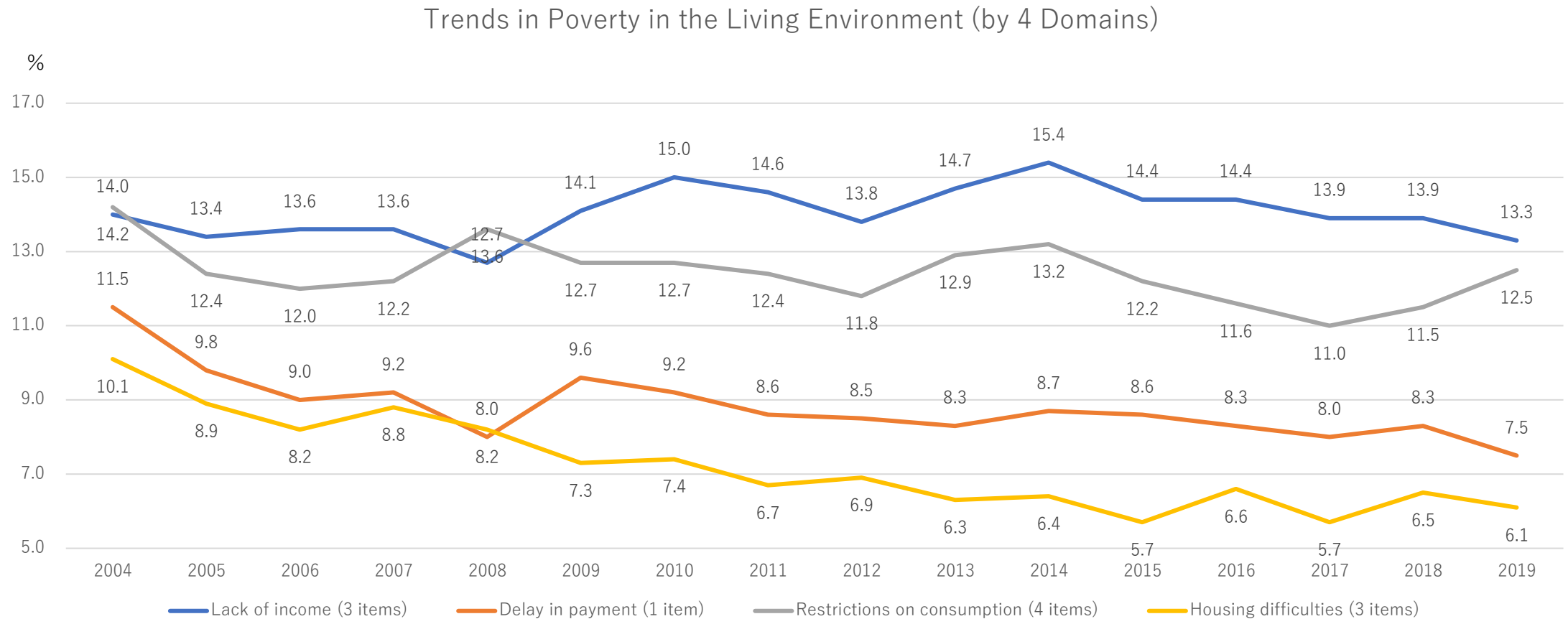
- It is based on the concept that "exclusion" and "poverty" are not determined by whether they are above or below a "line" arbitrarily determined by experts, but **are experienced and felt by each person**

Elements that make up living conditions (27 items)

収入の不足	支払いの遅延	消費の制約	住宅の困難
収入に対してローンの返済額が多い (3分の1以上)	直近12か月の間に電気・ガス料金の未払い	肉を買う	過密 (INSEE基準)
過去12ヶ月間に銀行借入した	直近12か月の間に家賃の未支払い	新しい衣服の購入	バスルームがない
収支を均衡させるに十分な収入がない	直近12か月の間に税金の未支払い	2足の靴の所有	トイレがない
貯蓄を取り崩す必要がある		1週間のバカンスに行く	温水がでない
貯蓄がない		両親や友人を自宅に招く	暖房設備がない
経済的に苦しい (主観)		プレゼントの購入	住居が狭い (主観)
		家具の買い替え	部屋を暖めるのが困難 (主観)
		住宅を快適な温度に保つ	湿気が多い (主観)
		過去2週間で満足な食事ができない日が1日あった	騒音の問題がある (主観)
3 / 6 (13.3%)	1 / 3 (7.5%)	4 / 9 (12.5%)	3 / 9 (6.1%)

INSEE, 2021, Poverty in living conditions from 2004 to 2019SRCV survey, INSEE Resultsより作成
Percentages in parentheses are figures for 2019

Changes in poverty in the living environment (for each of the four areas)



The Immaterial Dimension of Poverty

- Fostering guilt, humiliation, dishonor, discrimination, prejudice, → stigma

"What is at stake here is the manifestation of poverty on both the material and the immaterial planes, which must be understood not only as **an unfavorable and unstable economic condition**, but also as a **humiliating and depressing social relation**."

"These immaterial aspects come from the daily interactions between people living in poverty and the wider society, and **from how politicians, officials, and influential institutions like the media talk about and treat them**."

Ruth Lister = Author, Ichiro Matsumoto = Supervising translation, Masaru Tachiki = Translation (2011) "What is Poverty - Concepts, Discourse, and Politics" Akashi Shoten, p. 21

Conclusion

Future Prospects and Directions for Improvement

- Operational aspects: Simplification of application procedures, review of dependency inquiries
- Social awareness: Strengthening public relations and education to dispel stigma
- Fundamental institutional design: transparency and validity of the standard-setting process, linkage with other safety nets
- National Minimum Reference Point

National Minimum Reference Point

[A system in which conditions of use are set in accordance with the welfare standards]

- School attendance assistance (1~1.3 times or less than the welfare standard), welfare fund (1.8 times or less of the welfare standard), long-term care insurance premiums, insurance premiums, and disability independence support fees.
- Standards for local tax reductions and exemptions, public housing rent reductions and exemptions, reductions and exemptions from partial contributions to national health insurance premiums, and public loans provided by local governments
- Impact on the tax exemption base of inhabitant tax: Increased burden due to becoming a tax-free → taxable household
- Increased out-of-pocket limits for high-cost medical expenses, higher childcare fees, higher out-of-pocket payments for long-term care insurance, increased burden of using services for people with disabilities and children with disabilities, and increased out-of-pocket medical expenses for patients with intractable diseases
- "47 measures such as medical care, welfare, and pensions will have a negative impact" (January 2018, Ministry of Health, Labour and Welfare)